

Philosophy

#5:Knowing truth

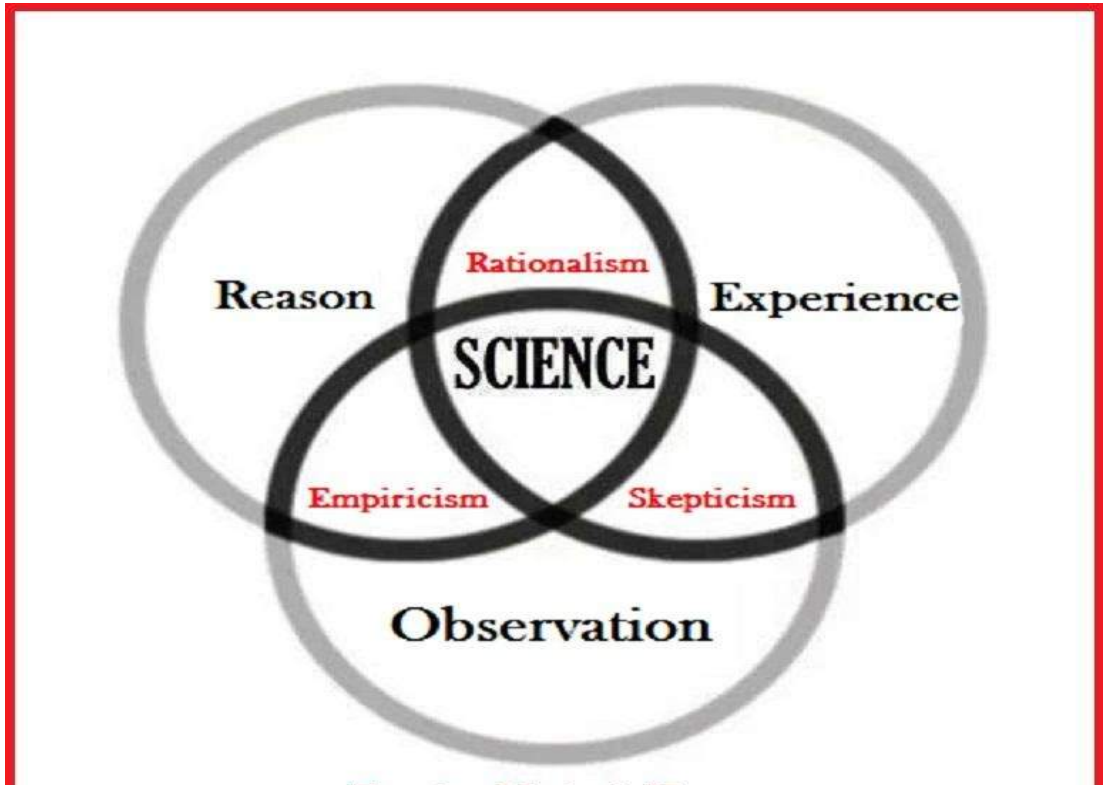
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Course Content

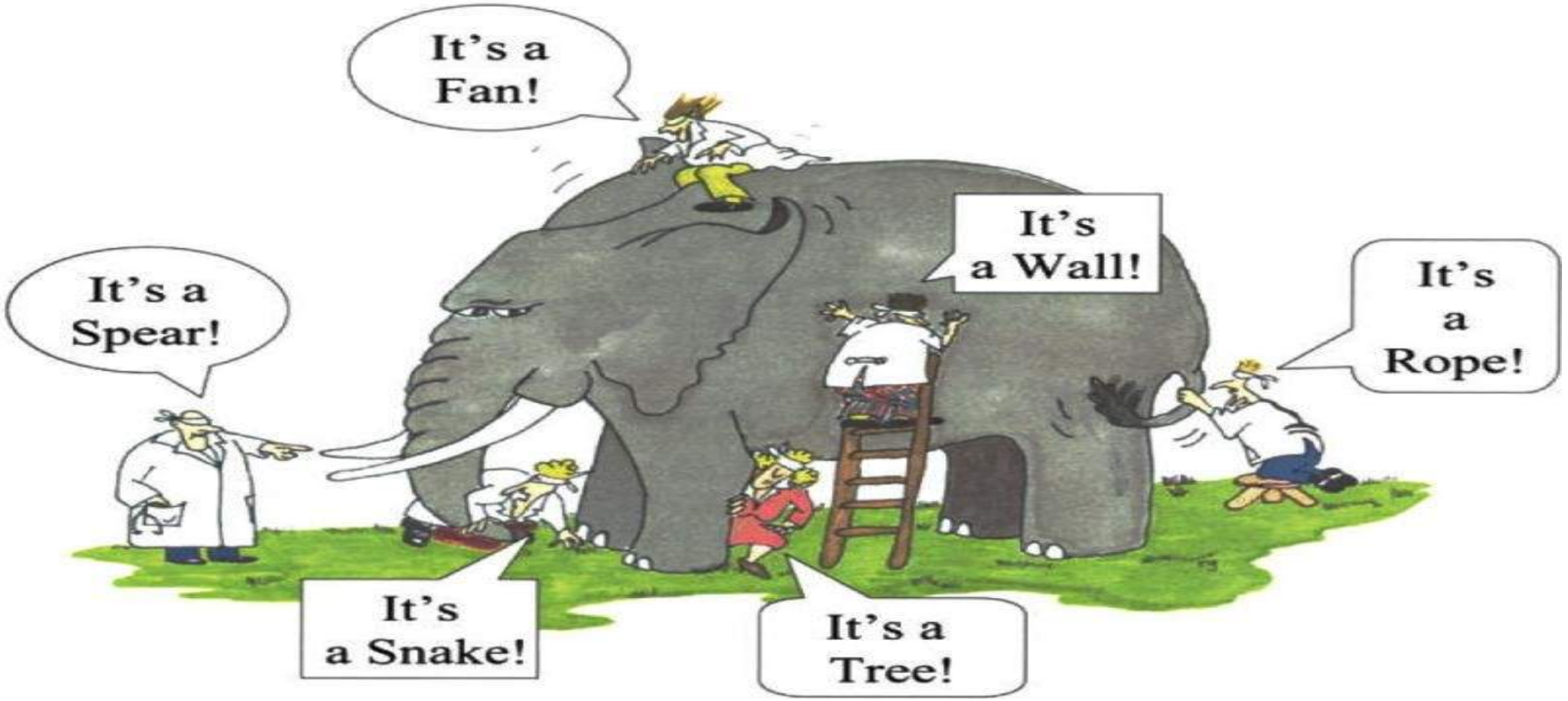
1. Common sense realism
2. Scientism
3. Rationalism
4. Empiricism



Critical questions

- What are the sources of knowledge?
- How do we know the reality?
- Can we know the truth?

Perception



Epistemology

Epistemology is the branch of philosophy that studies knowledge.
It attempts to answer the basic question: what distinguishes true knowledge from false knowledge?

"The theory or science of the method or grounds of knowledge."

—Webster's Dictionary

"The branch of philosophy that is concerned with the theory of knowledge. It is an inquiry into the nature and source of knowledge, the bounds of knowledge, and the justification of claims to knowledge."

—Feinberg

Sources of Knowledge:

- composed of ideas formed from observable data.
- knowledge obtained through the five bodily Senses.
- knowledge that is revealed through a transcendental reality.
- Knowledge is gained from empirical evidences.
- Knowledge is attained from scientific observation.





1.COMMON SENSE REALISM

KNOWLEDGE COMES FROM FIVE SENSES

1.COMMON SENSE REALISM

- The acquisition of knowledge is from five bodily senses such as see, touch,smell,hear and taste.
- The direct experience from five sense give truth and reality.
- We cannot completely rely on our five physical senses because senses deceive us often.
- Whatever we say around us from sense that is truth and reality.
- Truth reside around us in the world we need to use our senses because seeing is beleif.

- **Scientism** is the notion that natural science comprises the most authoritative worldview or form of human knowledge, and that it is superior to all other interpretations of life.

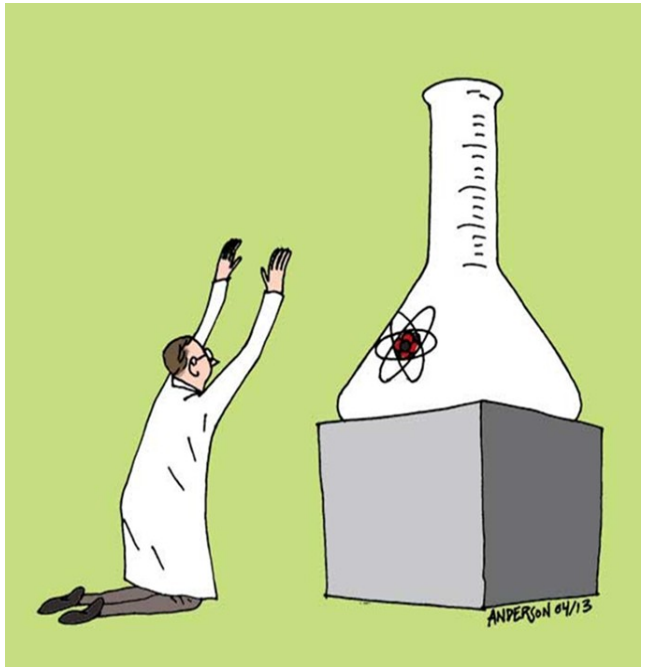


2.SCIENTISM

KNOLWEDGE COMES FROM SCIENTIFIC EXPERIMENT

2.SCIENTISM

- Scientific revolution begins with experiment of 100 species in laboratory by Aristotle.
- Copernicus changed the view of man to earth by experiment.
- Truths are justified by mathematical reason alone.
- Only tell those which is practically exist by verification.
- Faith in power of science to determine all truth and reality.





3.RATIONALISM

IDEAS ARE INNATE IN OUR MIND

Thought vs Experiement

Rationalism ≠ Science





RATIONALISM

- Intellect is an independent source of knowledge about world.
- It emphasized on rational capacity of human mind to know truth.
- All ideas are innate in mind which is recognized by reason alone.
- Mind whose essential attribute is thought is a key source of knowing.
- Some famous rationalist thinkers are Descartes, Leibnitz &Spinoza.
- Descartes said “I think therefore I exist.’
- Spinoza said “The cause of all things is innate in mind.”
- Leibnitz said “There are 2 kinds of truth: reason & facts”

Modern Rationalist

René Descartes was the "father" of modern philosophy, a Continental rationalist, and a dualist. He said there are two separate and distinct substances: material substance and mind.

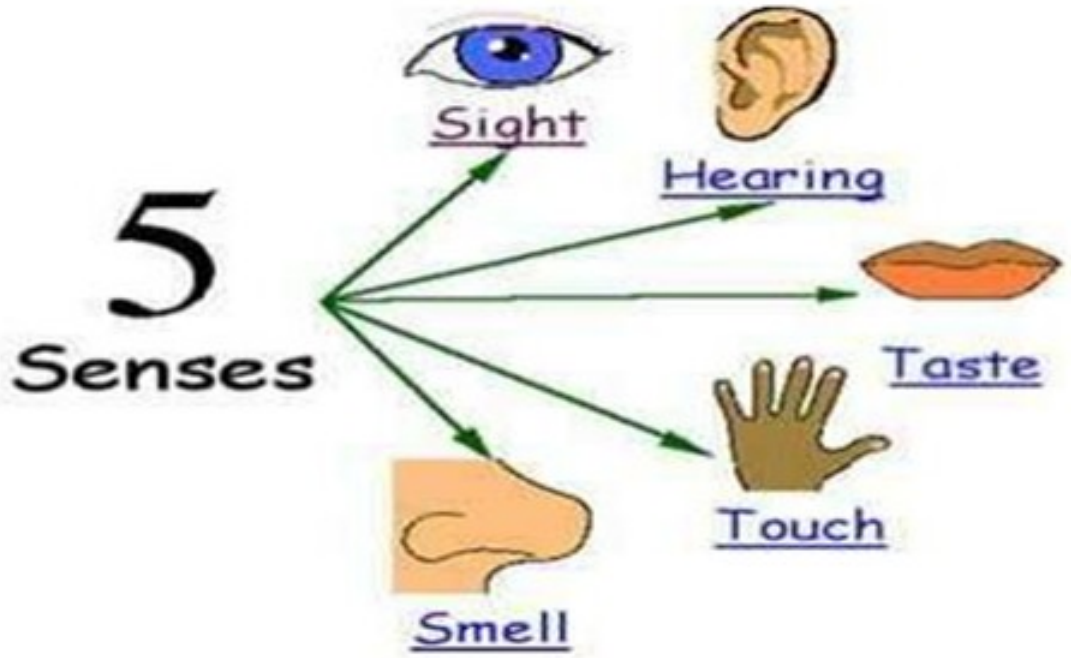
Spinoza was a neutralist and Continental rationalist. He maintained that thought and extension are attributes of a single substance.

Leibniz was a Continental rationalist who held that the ultimate constituents of reality are monads, which are nonmaterial, indivisible units of force.

I am thinking therefore I exist

- There is nothing of which can be certain
- Doubting everything reach toward true knowledge
- Doubting is a kind of thinking
- It is necessary that once in your life do doubt
- Anything that is thinking exists
- Believe in own existence cannot be doubted
- I am , I exist .It is direct self evident intuition
- We inquire all sort of knowledge
- God has innate ideas ,He is perfect doesn't deceive
- Evil genius has employed all energies to deceive us

Empiricism



Ideas and knowledge develop in our minds as a result of our sensory experiences.

4.EMPIRICISM

Ideas comes from experience

Empiricism

- Experience is an independent source of knowledge in spite of mind only.
- Senses-perception is reliable method of attaining truth and reality.
- We perceive objects indirectly by our representations in perceive mind.
- Mind is clean slate or tabula rasa which means it has no innate ideas.

- Hume said “Custom is the great guide of human life.”
- Locke said “No knowledge go beyond experience.”
- Berkley said “To be is to be perceived.”

Modern Empiricist

John Locke was a British empiricist who held that we perceive objects indirectly by means of our perceptions of them, some of which he believed were accurate copies of the real properties of objects.

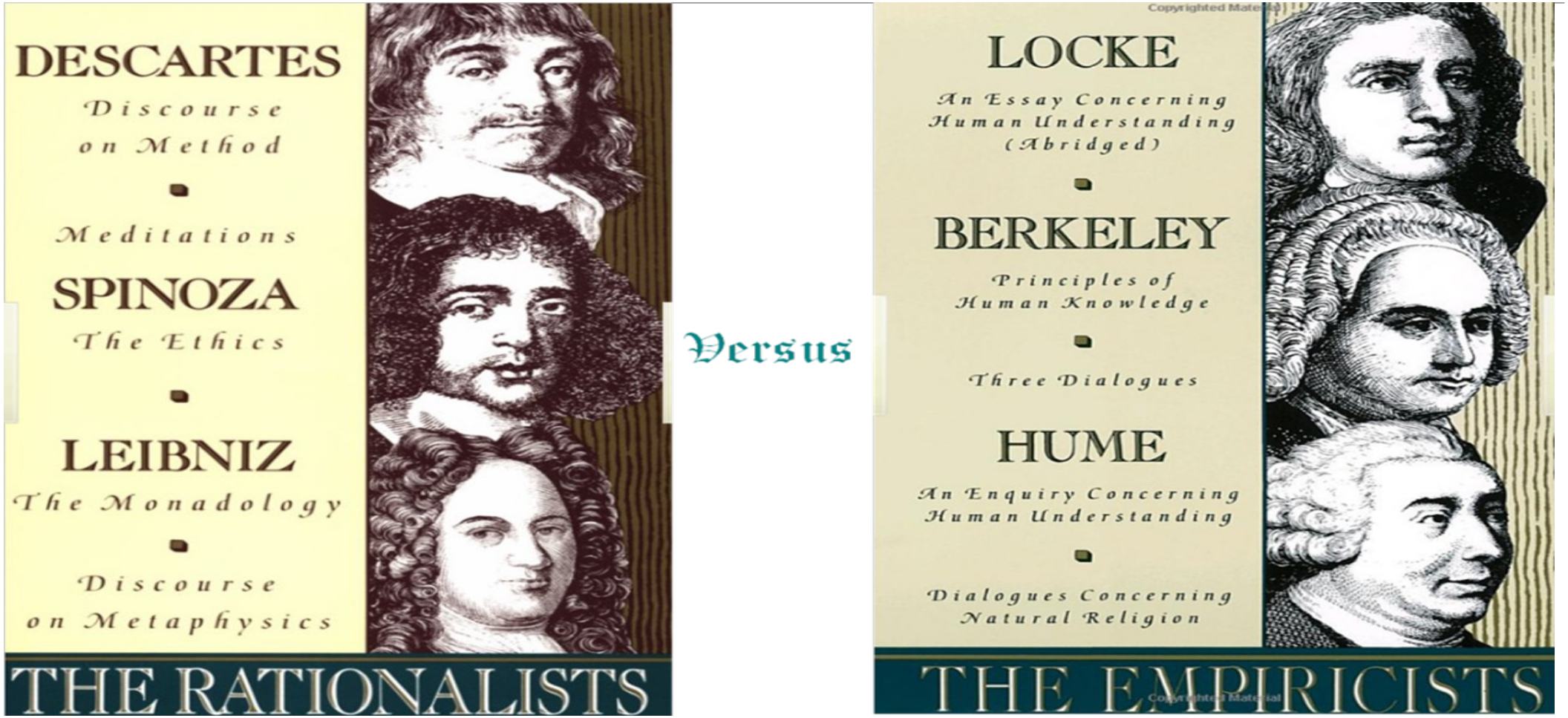
George Berkeley was a British empiricist and idealist who denied the existence of material substance and held that sensible objects exist only in the mind.

David Hume held that there is no metaphysical knowledge and maintained that knowledge is limited to what we experience. He summoned powerful arguments to question our supposed knowledge of the self, causality and the external world.

John Locke : Representative Realism

- Locke introduce the notion that we perceive objects indirectly by means of our sense
- we have a representation of them in our mind.
- Objects, (external to us) our perceived by our senses and we form ideas of them.
- Primary qualities are necessary qualities or attributes of something. They make it what it is. They are in the objects.
- Secondary or accidental qualities, are features like color, or taste. They are only in our minds, as part of our perceptions.

KEY THINKERS



Differences

RATIONALISM

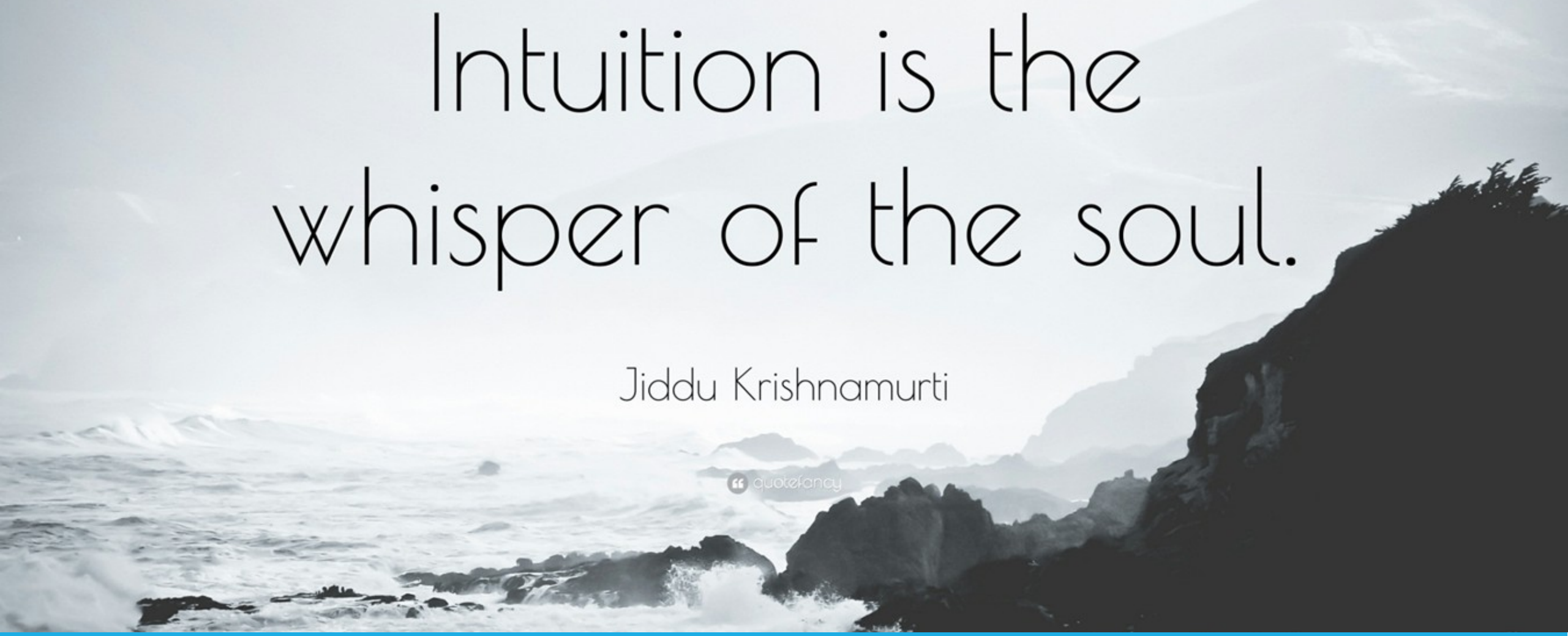
- Mind has innate ideas.
- They rely on reason comes from mind only.
- Sensation is the source of knowing.
- Knowledge is prior before experience.
- Knowledge is based on experimentation.
- Experience does not produce certainty.
- Mathematics is the paradigm of knowledge.
- It is mainly deductive form of reasoning.

EMPIRICISM

- Mind is blank slate.
- They rely on merely experiences.
- Reason is the key source of knowing.
- Knowledge comes after experiences.
- Knowledge is based on use of logic.
- Reason is just an armchair discussion.
- Scientific experiment is the paradigm.
- It is mainly inductive form of reasoning.

Differences





INTUITIONISM

IDEAS COME FROM INNER SENSE

Intuition: Just know that something is good.

- It is mystical or supernatural experience of knowledge.
- Most religious thoughts are based upon it.
- Truth comes from supersensory ,super rational faculty.
- It is the cultivation of most inner experience.
- Revelation is the priority over all other sources.
- Great art work of poet and music also show experience.
- Intuitions are capable of motivating behavior to know.

Summary

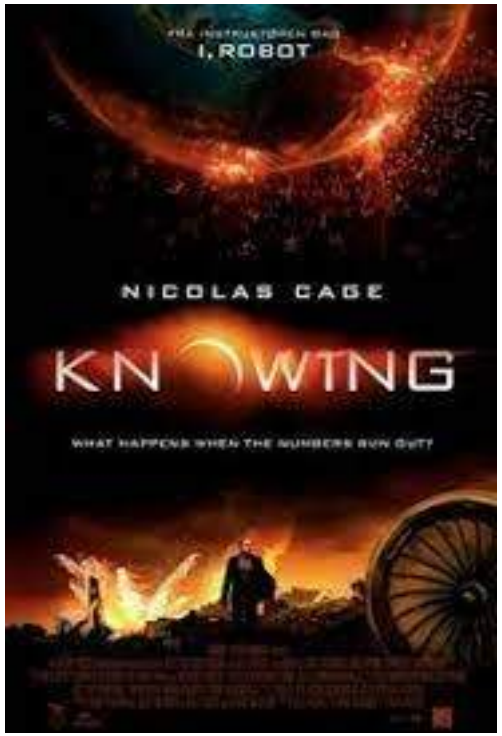
Intuition:	It believe on inner feel
Sense realism:	It is through senses
Rationalism:	It makes sense for reason
Empiricism:	it believe in experiment and evidence.
Science:	It can be demonstrated to be so

Movie review on Epistemology

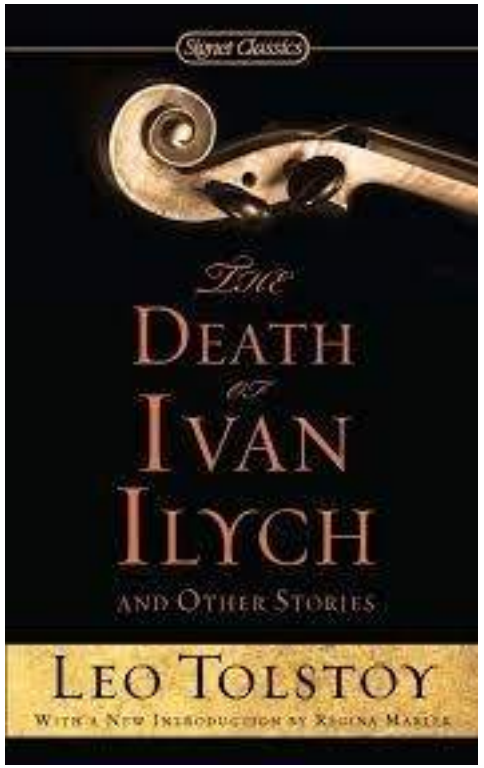


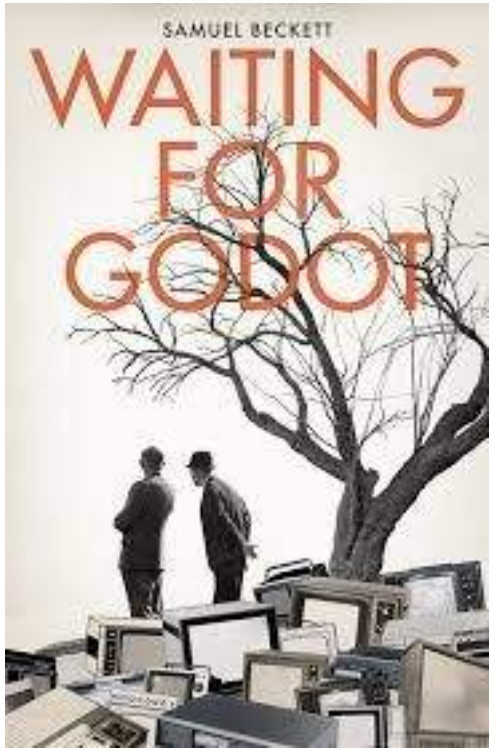


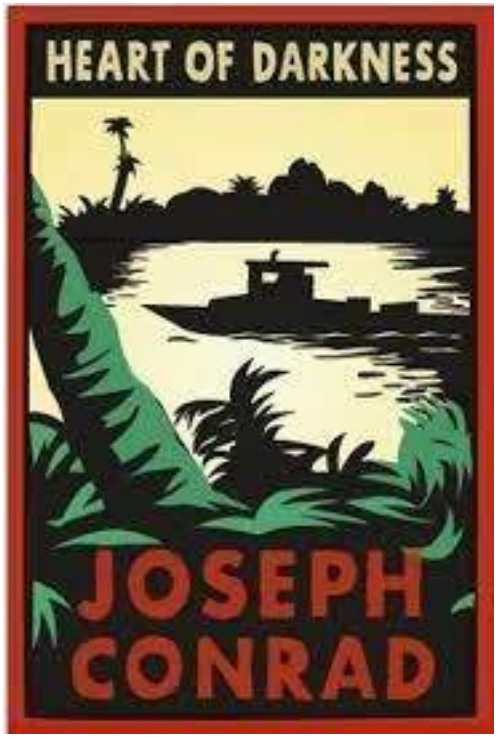




Literature review on Knowing reality









http://www.youtube.com/@Snathought

Thank You !